New Zealand Rogaining Association AGM,
Monday 27 February 2012, 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Present: Trevor Merrifield, Bill Kennedy, Grant Hunter, Tim Farrant, Pete Squires
Apologies: nil

1. **Matters arising from Minutes AGM 2011**

Sponsorship of junior events
NZRA provided sponsorship for a three-event Canterbury rogaine series (waiving Navlight fees and public liability insurance levies for juniors) as well as the annual Taranaki schools rogaine champs (Navlight fees).

2. **President's report**

Peter Squires presented his report, which summarises achievements over the year (Appended)

3. **Financial report**

Treasurer Trevor Merrifield presented the annual accounts of the Association

- Accounts were for NZRA overall, since the separate account for WRC2010 was closed during the year and funds assimilated into the main accounts.
- Year end situation for NZRA is ca. $69,319.38 of net liquid assets.
- A small loss ($3846) was incurred this year, related to liabilities from WRC2010 from the previous year.
- Net proceeds from WRC2010 was $47,357,23

The accounts for 2011 were accepted (PS/TF).

4. **Election of Officers**

President: Peter Squires (BK/TF)
Secretary: Grant Hunter (TM/BK) (Note 1)
Treasurer: Trevor Merrifield (GH/BK)
Committee: Douglas Woods, Dave Laurie, Emma De Lacey, Tim Farrant, Nick Collins (PS/TM collectively)

With no nominations exceeding places to be filled there was no voting.

Regional representatives:

Auckland –Shaun Collins
Taranaki – Annie Sanderson
Bay of Plenty/central NI – Mark Copeland
Taupo – Darren Ashmore
Wellington –Jamie Stewart
Marlborough – Alan Holdaway, Mondo Kopua
Central Otago – Ed Stevens
Otago – Bob Cunninghame

IRF Representatives: Alan Holdaway, Nick Collins

Technical roles:

Webmaster and membership: Bill Kennedy (PS/GH)
Navlight: Jac Woudberg (GH/PS)

Gear controller and Assets: Dave Laurie (PS/TM)
NZ Champs liaison: Tim Farrant (TF/GH)

Notes to appointments
*1. Secretary***:** Grant accepted this role conditional on a 'national communication coordinator' role being assigned to another committee member, in anticipation of a growing role in this.

5. Other business

World Championship (WRC2010), 20/21 November)
Noted that although this event took place and was largely wrapped up organisationally in the previous year, some tidying up, particularly finalising payments and accounts, extended into the reporting year.

National rogaine series
We look forward to the planned national series of events, not only for the direct event benefit, but also as the current flagship mechanism to help develop a more truly national functioning of the Association, to benefit rogaining.

Association email contact points
Noted that the Association has no electronic or physical address contact points, other than personal contacts for office bearers, except those set up for event transactions (entry fees) and Facebook. We agreed that having such contact points sets up a further layer of complexity for individuals and the Association and that given relatively light traffic flows, we would continue to operate as at present, for now.

Communication media
We note the setting up of a Facebook Page, with thanks to Chrys Horn. We discussed further widening the media/communication, in particular to ensure a 'popular' image of rogaining reaches younger people. Shifts in emphasis include having more close-in and concentrated check points and 'special task' sections on courses to appeal to spectators and to enable action photo coverage, and greater emphasis on action photography to tell the rogaining story.

Outdoor safety legislation
Noted that the Adventure Activity Regulations 2011 impact on recreational activities offered for a fee and (deliberately) exposing participants to outdoor risk. Though rogaining is not inherently a risk activity and is unlikely to come within this context, it is something we need to review and confirm during the year.

Next meetings
- Aim for late April for a general meeting, no date set.
- National meeting – proposed to be at least annual event, following from the November 2011, and tentatively in October/November 2012.
- Noted that those organizing the national series may also meet during the year in a national context.

Meeting ended.

www.rogaine.org.nz

President's Annual Report 2010 – 2011
(Presented February 2012)

This has been a very busy year for NZRA.

Hosting the World Championships at Cheviot in November, with all its international debate about entry limitation and qualification, and the handling of entry fees from around the world, was a huge and largely un-anticipated challenge. It was also a huge effort to find and approach the nearly 80 landowners involved. We are humbled and grateful to these people for their enthusiastic support. The building of relationships between NZRA and the rural community has been a most worthwhile outcome from this event.

The event itself was successful in spite of the unfortunate timing of a southerly rain front throughout the entire 24 hours. The Model course at Mt. Vulcan three days earlier experienced very high temperatures by contrast. The model course was attended by over 50 teams, mostly from overseas. They appreciated the opportunity to experience our terrain, mapping style, fences, and weather.

The extra-ordinary work of many volunteers made the WRC2010 what it was. I heartily thank all the volunteers for their commitment and effort to make this happen. Without diminishing the efforts of others, I would particularly like to recognise the outstanding contributions made by Phil Bones, Bill Kennedy, and Grant Hunter in particular, and by Alan Holdaway for his scrupulous vetting of the entire course on at least two occasions. Nick Collins also contributed significantly to the international deliberations.

We also hosted the National Championships in February, thanks to Mondo Kopua and team in Blenheim. This was an excellent, if physical, course, set in surprisingly delightful and varied country on the back-door of Blenheim. I suspect that this venue could host more events in the future.

National championships tend to be poorly supported, which is discouraging considering the great effort it requires of the organisers. People may be scared off by the thought of 24 hours of competition, but I would encourage teams to consider splitting their time in two, and having a few hours of rest at night. This is widely done in overseas rogaines and brings a sense of camaraderie to the hash-house in the evening.

It is also disappointing that the NZOF have failed to organise a national championship for 2012. Traditionally, this task has alternated between them and NZRA, and it was their turn. Many thanks to Bob Cunninghame in Dunedin for stepping in with the event now planned for November 2012.

Resulting from a meeting in Wellington, we are intending to create a "national series" of four or six rogaines, based on events six hours or longer, and with an equal number in the North and South islands. While exact details are yet to be finalised, the plan is that individual scores will be tracked, and the person with the highest total from all but one event will be the winner. It is anticipated that this series will improve the participation rate and quality of larger rogaines.

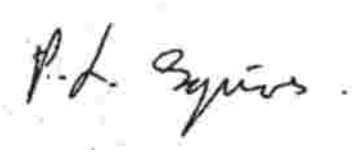
One of the objectives of NZRA is to “encourage rogaining”, and not just within the NZRA itself. It is really good to see that people are now organising their own events, and providing really enjoyable sport for a growing number of participants. The efforts of all these organisers is much appreciated.

Thanks to Chrys Horn, we now have Facebook on our website. This should provide a medium for the younger rogainers to share their experiences, and encourage others to try their hand (and feet) at this fun sport.

The NZRA has been active in promoting wider and younger participation in other ways also. We have provided sponsorship for the Canterbury Rogaine series, and also for the Taranaki School championships. This latter event has been running for some years now, and has a very large and growing participation. It is surely developing rogainers, and rogaining leaders, for the future, and is one of the most valuable things we can do.

We face challenges going forward. We need to find a way of splitting the function of NZRA into local operations like our local Heights of Winter and Office Hours rogaines, and into national and international concerns such as WRC entry qualification criteria and rules, national championships, and national series. Rogaining is as much for recreational fun-seekers and volunteers as it is for elite competition, and we must keep that balance in mind. We are looking right now for people to assist us, who may have an interest in either of these areas. If you would like to enjoy the benefits of helping to organise an event (it is fun – believe me) or if you have an interest in the competitive side, either nationally or internationally, we would love to hear from you.

I wish all you rogainers a happy and eventful rogaining year.



Peter Squires, President.